the attempts to protest against the impending execution of Mohammad Afzal Guru were gaining momentum, two other events occurred in Delhi which merit our attention. The first was a demonstration against the arrest and forced feeding of Irom Sharmila, a young Manipuri woman who has been on a continuous hunger strike against the AFSPA, and the suspected 'encounter' death of Irshad Ahmed Lone, a young Kashmiri man in Delhi. While the first may have got some attention, the second is once again wrapped in silence. Protests rocked the Channapora neighbourhood of Srinagar at the manner in which his naked body showed visible marks of torture. But the Delhi Police, and its Special Cell, thought it wise not to display him as yet another trophy in their war against terror. Perhaps, they thought, it would be too much to exhibit another 'encounter' in the days leading up to Afzal's execution.

In the light of this silence, it may be instructive to read a report that appeared on the website of the *Kashmir Times* newspaper on 11 October. It merits a lengthy quotation.

Kashmiri youth tortured, killed in Delhi Protests rock Srinagar, custodial killing alleged

SRINAGAR, OCT 11: People took to streets and held strong demonstrations at Channapora here today in protest against the murder of a local youth, Irshad Ahmad Lone, an automobile engineer, in New Delhi. Police burst smoke shells and resorted to lathi charge to disperse the demonstrators, who retaliated by pelting stones on cops . . .

The bereaved family accused Delhi police of arresting Irshad and later killing him in custody. According to them the youth had gone to New Delhi for a job in an automobile company on September 21. He was arrested by police there and brutally tortured. Later they were informed by a cop from the union capital on telephone that Irshad is in an unconscious condition in a hospital. The youth later succumbed to his injuries.

Ali Mohammad father of Irshad said that in the morning of October 8 he received a telephone call at his residence from New Delhi. The caller identified himself as assistant sub inspector Ram Ji Lal of Inter- State Bus Terminus (ISBT) police chowki Kashmiri Gate. The cop asked him whether he knew Irshad. Ali Mohammad informed that he was his son. The subinspector told Ali Mohammad that his son was in an unconscious condition at Sushrutra Trauma Centre.

Irshad's brother, Tariq Ahmad, rushed to Delhi. According to him, his brother was in an unconscious condition with visible torture marks on his body. Irshad's arms, throat and head had torture marks. He later succumbed to his injuries. Tariq asked Ram Ji Lal as to what had happened to Irshad. The cop claimed that they found Irshad in a naked condition on a highway at ISBT Kashmiri Gate and that he was unconscious. Asked as to how he got the telephone number of their residence in Srinagar, Ram Ji Lal claimed that Irshad gave the number before he lost his consciousness.

The bereaved family members said if police got their phone number from Irshad why it did not ask him as to who had tortured him. They said Irshad was arrested, tortured and then killed by Delhi police. Since this morning large number of people visited the affected family and were waiting for the body till late this evening. The body is likely to reach here during night hours . . .